Q+A

BORN TO SHINE

Fresh from his success at Coachella, **Diljit Dosanjh** is starring in two biopics on legendary Punjabi singer, Amar Singh Chamkila

Q. Two biopics on Amar Singh Chamkila, both starring you.... How are they different?
Jodi, in Punjabi, was a theatrical release. *Chamkila* is for Netflix, so the canvas is different. *Jodi*'s audience knew Chamkila well. So the emphasis was to portray the person behind the greatest star of Punjabi music. In Imtiaz sir's adaptation, the effort is also towards letting people know who Chamkila was. As an artist, I couldn't have asked for more—getting two opportunities to pay tribute to such a fantastic artist.

Q. Music is the backbone of both movies—and your ideal zone to be in...
Oh, yes! I couldn't have been luckier. I had fun doing these projects.... As an artist, I couldn't have asked for better platforms to polish my singing and acting. And, more importantly, to relive that era of Chamkila's music in my way.

Q. What was performing at Coachella like?
"*Punjabi aa gaye Coachella oye* [Punjabis have arrived at Coachella]!" is how I acknowledged my predecessors' work that made it possible for a man not comfortable talking in English to sing on that stage. I was really anxious before the show. Someone from my team pointed out that Punjabi would be spoken for the first time on that kind of platform. That made me think this was not just about me—it was much bigger than an individual.

Q. What other projects are you looking forward to?
All of them! Though I would be happy if you pray for them, instead of asking for too many details—I am beginning to get a little superstitious about things [laughs]. I am looking forward to *Crew*.... I am on a high wave and I am enjoying it, touch wood!

with Aarti Kapur Singh

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